

Pairi Daiza Foundation Grant

Cover Letter

Overview

- **Project title:** Acoustic Monitoring for Migratory Birds in Lithuania – Land of the Storks
- **Principal investigator:** Yi-Chin (Sunny) Tseng - University of Northern British Columbia, Canada
- **Local partners:** Tomas Pikūnas - biosphere manager in Žuvintas Biosphere Reserve in Lithuania; and Modestas Bružas - biologist in Curonian Spit National Park in Lithuania
- **Current support:** National Geographic Early Career Grant (EC-KOR-53792R-18)
- **Funding requested:** Pairi Daiza Foundation Grant for Biodiversity and Conservation Research

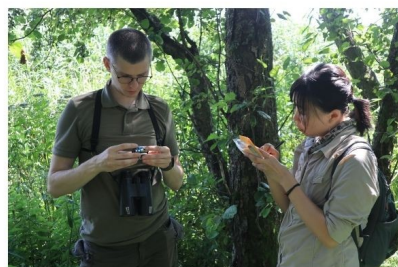
Summary

The project aims to establish Lithuania's first long-term passive acoustic monitoring program for migratory birds, providing baseline biodiversity data across key habitats. Initial pilot recordings were collected during the 2025 breeding season, demonstrating strong potential for large-scale implementation. With support from the Pairi Daiza Foundation, we will continue and expand monitoring during the 2026 breeding season at two ecologically significant sites—Žuvintas Biosphere Reserve and Curonian Spit National Park—with full collaboration from local partners.

Fieldwork will occur from May to July 2026, preceded by logistical planning and equipment preparation, and followed by data analysis and reporting by December 2026. The project will deliver a comprehensive baseline dataset of avian acoustic activity to support long-term biodiversity monitoring and conservation management in Lithuania.

Local collaborators

The project is supported by local partners at Žuvintas Biosphere Reserve and Curonian Spit National Park. Principal investigator Sunny Tseng conducted pilot fieldwork with Modestas, Tomas, and Arūnas in 2025, who are committed to continuing collaboration during the 2026 season.



Curonian Spit National Park

Modestas Bružas, biologist (left)
Sunny Tseng, bioacoustic researcher (right)



Žuvintas Biosphere Reserve

Tomas Pikūnas, biosphere manager (right)
Arūnas Pranaitis, ornithologist (left)

